

The blossoms
can be smoked
as ritual incense

Some Wiccans add
blossoms to candles
for handfasting



▲ **Apple blossom** and apples are linked to many goddesses, including Aphrodite and Freya, and seen as the fruit of love and immortality.



▲ **Sage** belongs to the genus *Salvia*, which is Latin for healing or rescue, and was once widely regarded as the best herb for treating fevers. Some believed it could also bring immortality or wisdom.

Healing plants

Since prehistoric times, people have believed in the special powers of plants to help and heal. On one level, they have been used as medicines, and the therapeutic qualities of many herbs, long known through practice, have now often been verified by science. The herbal (book of properties of herbs) was the healer's equivalent of the modern doctor's drug guide. It has also long been believed that many plants have magical powers beyond their ability to cure—for instance, bringing love, money, or protection from the evil eye.



▲ **Rosemary**, signifying remembrance, has been placed in graves of loved ones since ancient Roman times. The herb was also thought to ward off evil spirits and witches.



▲ **Bamboo** is considered to have magical properties for promoting good health and long life. Bamboo wands were used by Taoists to summon water deities.



▲ **Basil** is believed to calm the mind and bring happiness. It is also linked to money, and so it is used in spells to create wealth. Carrying a basil leaf in your wallet is said to help attract riches.



▲ **Aloe vera** is hung over doors in Africa and the Middle East to bring good luck and drive away evil. Medically, the plant is used to treat wounds, burns, and skin irritations.